

CL LEDGER, AMENDMENT 01

Pre-freeze self-correction. Does not consume the single completion pass. · 2026-08-25

Trigger. Stephen's reader objections to three hooks in the earlier `hooks-claude-twelve` draft identified one defect with one cause: **the premise required competent investigators not to do an obvious thing.** "That phone evidence would have been gathered by police at the time." "Competent police would have done as a simple matter of process." "Doesn't pass the sniff test."

Kill Gate Zero already forbids this under **professionals remain competent**. I broke it and did not catch it. Two rows of the submitted ledger carry the same defect and are withdrawn below.

Influence pairs are preserved. The defect is the conception, not the allocation, so both replacements keep their assigned pair and family. **All four reserve pairs remain unused.**

WITHDRAWN: CL-Co1 (original)

The interchange stabbing, eleven phones still in the pockets of frightened children.

Decisive rejection reason. Police interviewing forty witnesses at a public transport interchange would have sought the recordings as routine. The premise needs them not to have, and no reader believes it. Retained in the ledger as a rejected row per section 9.

REPLACEMENT: CL-Co1

Family: CONTESTED · **Assigned influences:** E1+E6 · **Primary engine:** E1

Hook. A seventeen-year-old girl was killed at a house in Rivermouth and a nineteen-year-old was convicted. Six other teenagers gave statements that night. One of them was fourteen, and she gave hers in her own living room with her father sitting beside her. She is twenty-nine now, and she says what she told them was what he told her to say.

Reason to care. A frightened child said what she was told to say, and a man has served ten years on it. **Central question.** Is she telling the truth now, or was she telling it then? **Living tension.** Her father, alive, still in the same house, and the only person who knows what she is about to do. **Stake:** present danger · **Situation:** wrong person blamed · **Payoff:** clear or restore

Influence transfer. E1, one disputed night the audience can argue before any proof. E6, the danger is live and directed at the witness, and the people around her see it before she does. **Wrong hypothesis.** She is a troubled adult reinterpreting a childhood memory under the influence of a campaign, which is a real phenomenon and which her own family will say convincingly. **Player reconstruction.** Assemble the six statements into a comparison of what each teenager was asked and who was present; it shows hers is the only account containing a detail no fourteen-year-old at that party could have known, which unlocks the person who did know it. **Havenbay necessity.** Rivermouth is where the families of all seven still live, three streets apart. She cannot recant without every other family knowing by evening, which is the mechanism keeping her silent and the reason it held for ten years. **Living consequence.** The witness, whose household, family and physical safety change the week she speaks. **Resistance.** Her father. Least-cost response is not threat but

diagnosis: he tells everyone, kindly and publicly, that his daughter is unwell. **Process dependency.**

PENDING APPROVAL: what does Havenbay require when a witness who was a minor recants, who assesses it, and does the original interviewing officer have any role? **Small-number test.** NOT DECISIVE. The turn is a detail inside a human account. **Closest retired resemblance.** NONE. Shares no component with the withdrawn row.

Why this one survives the objection that killed the original. The reason nobody found this at the time is that a fourteen-year-old was interviewed correctly, with an appropriate adult present, and the appropriate adult was the problem. Nothing here requires an investigator to skip a step.

WITHDRAWN: CL-U02 (original)

The woman who vanished twenty-two years ago and the man four suburbs away nobody knocked on.

Decisive rejection reason. "Because the story was too tidy to check" is the whole premise and it is not credible. The named man she supposedly left with is the first door any competent investigation opens. Retained in the ledger as a rejected row per section 9.

REPLACEMENT: CL-U02

Family: UNRESOLVED · **Assigned influences:** E2+E5 · **Primary engine:** E2

Hook. A man went into the water off Pier 13 twenty years ago and was never found. Everyone at his wake knew what had happened the week before and it was agreed, in the way these things are agreed, that nothing would be said in front of his mother. His mother died last month. Three people now want to talk and none of them will go first.

Reason to care. A whole room kept a promise to an old woman, and the promise outlived every reason for it.

Central question. Was the silence a kindness, and does it stop being one the moment she dies? **Living tension.** The man the silence protects, who paid for her funeral, and who every one of those three has reason to be grateful to. **Stake:** body · **Situation:** person, identity, body, or evidence missing · **Payoff:** find or name

Influence transfer. E2, people broadly knew, nobody acted, and the place must now face its own silence.

E5, recovering him is the central mystery and the emotional payoff. **Wrong hypothesis.** He drowned. He had been drinking, the pier is genuinely dangerous, and three guilty consciences about an argument the week before is not a homicide. **Player reconstruction.** Assemble what each of the three remembers of that week into one account of the argument; the three versions agree on a detail none of them realises the others know, which unlocks where he was between the argument and the water. **Havenbay necessity.** Pier 13's currents determine where a body should have come ashore and he never did, which is why the harbour has always half-known. The water is the reason the question stayed open and the reason nobody could close it. **Living consequence.** The three witnesses, bound by twenty years of accepted generosity from the man they would have to name. **Resistance.** That man. Least-cost response is continued generosity, which costs him little and makes speaking against him feel like theft. **Process dependency.** PENDING APPROVAL: how does Havenbay treat a twenty-year-old presumed drowning where remains were never recovered, and what reopens it? **Small-number test.** NOT DECISIVE. The turn is three overlapping human memories, and no tide, distance or interval is load-bearing. *Recorded: my retired C1 died on a tide interval. Nothing quantitative decides anything here; the water sets the question, not the answer.* **Closest retired**

resemblance. Claude 1, Slack Water, RETIRED. Decisive difference: C1 asked the audience to care about a half-hour tide window and both readers refused. Here the tide explains only why the question stayed open, and the case is decided by a room full of people who made a promise.

LEDGER STATE AFTER AMENDMENT

Twelve active rows. Two withdrawn rows retained with decisive reasons. All twelve assigned pairs intact. All four reserve pairs unused.

Primary engine unchanged. C01 remains E1, U02 remains E2, so the distribution self-check in the submitted ledger stands without recalculation.

Stake unchanged. C01 present danger, U02 body.

Situation unchanged. C01 wrong person blamed, U02 person identity body or evidence missing.

One register moves. U02's payoff was find or name and remains find or name. No change.

THE DEFECT CLASS, RECORDED FOR THE POOL CONTROLLER

Three of my hooks failed on one thing, and it is not covered by any distribution register: **the premise required competent investigators not to do an obvious thing.** Kill Gate Zero forbids it and it still reached a reader twice, because a hook is assessed before the Gate Zero table exists.

Recommend the assembly pass apply one added check to all twenty-four rows: **name the reason the decisive material was not found at the time, and confirm that reason does not require anyone to have been incompetent.** Legitimate reasons include material that did not exist then, a witness who was a child, a promise now released by a death, a record held in another jurisdiction, and a lawful destruction. An investigator simply not bothering is not one.